

Google's big WiFi Gift

Google gave away free WiFi to many American airports as a year-end gift, but we suspect this is a win-win situation

Berners Lee apologises

Tim Berners Lee says he's sorry for the inconvenience of the double forward slash in web site addresses, which he now says was not really necessary

Windows Azure on the horizon

Windows 7 is not the only recent operating system that was launched by Microsoft. Windows Azure is a variant that was also recently launched, and it is meant as a cloud operating system for web services. There is surprisingly, almost no media hype around Azure, and very few people have even heard of it, probably why there are few developers using the API and SDK to create web based applications for the platform.

Azure is a set of three products including Windows Azure, an operating system for web based applications, SQL Azure for handling databases, and .NET services which acts as a bridge between two Azure based web applications, which can interact with each other directly instead of interfacing indirectly through the cloud. The great aspect about this

other platforms and services on the web, almost anything can plug in easily with everything else. Users can look forward to great mashups that consist of Microsoft and Google services for example. The few demos currently on the Azure web site proves this point. Twitri, one of the featured services, posts updates on Twitter, Facebook, and on e-mail, if you enter your flight information. High flying tweeple apart, the only other featured app is some kind of a race tracker. While not in beta

stage, Windows Azure is open to the public for use till the end of January 2010.

We have been waiting long for the company that revolutionized the desktop PC experience to jump wholeheartedly into the web and dazzle us. A step in that direction is the Bing search engine, which seems to

Social engineers still own you

Leading newspapers around the world had headlines screaming out a major compromise in the accounts of Yahoo!, Gmail and MSN Live mail users. Various lists of compromised ids were hosted on pastebin.com, rapidshare and megaupload. Users were encouraged to change their passwords immediately.

Almost two months on, it would be fair to expect internet-savvy users to change their

passwords. The sad truth is that despite all the publicity, a large chunk of the compromised accounts had passwords that still worked. This led to a kind of mayhem that can be very troublesome and very personal.

It is not about understanding the protocols of the internet, or working some magic in the wires, it really never was. People are easily fooled, and security experts often cite them as the weakest link in the chain. The problem was that a lot of the usernames and passwords for the email ids was the same as the login details of a major social networking site - Facebook.

When the list was unleashed on a forum with the suggestion to wreck havoc on the Facebook accounts, a number of anonymous people went crazy, posting lewd photos on accounts, hijacking the accounts by changing the passwords, having conversations with the friends of the compromised accounts and so on.

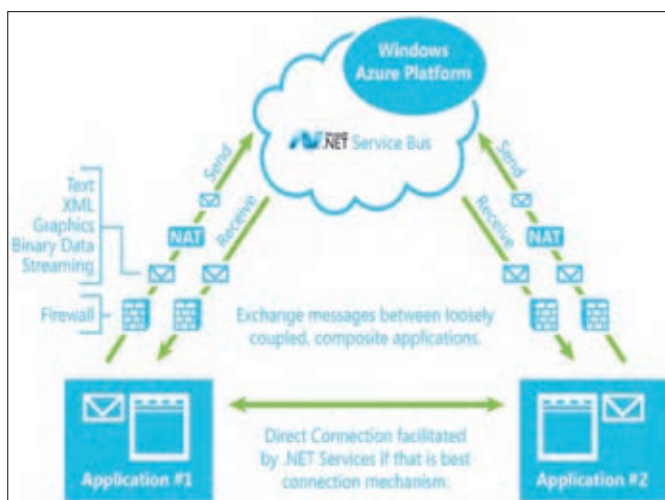
Further, those who discovered that their Facebook accounts had been compromised had no clue of the origin

of the mischief, and believed that someone in their own friend circle was responsible. There are little chances of legal repercussions to those who participated in the invasion, as they were from all over the planet. Most mischief makers didn't even use a proxy.

There are very simple steps that you can take to avoid such an incident from happening to you. Every time you enter a username and password, check the URL to ensure that you are on the correct site. If you get a mail that says your password for a web site has been replaced (Facebook is the most common target), do not click on the buttons no matter how close to the real thing they appear. Instead, cross check by going to the web site in question, and logging in.

Check Point empowers business to monitor web 2.0 use

Check Point is actively developing a security suite to address concerns of employees using social networking sites. This is not a simple matter of employees wasting time on web 2.0 services while at work, but a much deeper concern. A web 2.0 presence is an integral part of major companies, and Check Point offers software that makes it easier for companies to monitor the activities of their employees not only on Facebook and Twitter, but on games, widgets and other applications. Many employees have to interact with customers on web 2.0 platforms, and Check Point provides a way to ensure that mistakes do not happen, such as the notorious case where a Microsoft employee broadcasted architecture plans of the next Windows OS, code named Windows 8 on his LinkedIn status. **1**



The .NET Services that are part of Microsoft's cloud offering

approach is that finally, software companies are coming out with products that are compatible with each other. This means that almost every new platform or service that comes out will be compatible with

be making steady gains in the search engine share because of the supposed higher search relevancy, although many point out that this may simply be because Bing is two keystrokes short of Google.